PARLIAMENTARY DEBATES

(HANSARD)

FIFTH SERIES—VOLUME 439

HOUSE OF COMMONS

OFFICIAL REPORT

SECOND SESSION OF THE THIRTY-EIGHTH PARLIAMENT
OF THE UNITED KINGDOM OF GREAT BRITAIN
AND NORTHERN IRELAND
10 GEORGE VI

TENTH VOLUME OF SESSION 1946-47

THIS VOLUME MAY BE CITED AS 439 H.C. DEB. 5 s.

COMPRISING PERIOD FROM
23rd JUNE—11th JULY 1947

LONDON
HIS MAJESTY'S STATIONERY OFFICE
1947
Price 11s. 0d. net

and what steps he is taking to protest against the second Japanese whaling expedition sanctioned by the U.S. authorities against the wishes of the Australian Government.

39. **Mr. Harrison** asked the Secretary of State for Foreign Affairs if the protest made to the U.S. State Department, regarding permission being granted on two occasions for Japanese whaling expeditions to operate in the Antarctic by the U.S. authorities, have resulted in assurances that proper consultation with other Powers will take place before any further permits are issued.

44. **Dr. Haden Guest** asked the Secretary of State for Foreign Affairs if he is aware that a second whaling expedition to the Antarctic has been authorised by the General Officer Commanding the Occupation Forces in Japan without prior consultation with the Governments of Australia and New Zealand; and what conditions have been imposed on Japanese whalers to prevent a destructive inroad into an important source of world fat supplies by indiscriminate slaughter of whales.

Mr. Mayhew: The U.S. Government did not consult with the other interested Governments, which include the Governments of the United Kingdom, Australia and New Zealand, before authorising the second Japanese whaling expedition in the Antarctic. Our Ambassador in Washington is being instructed to re-open this question with the United States Government.

FORMOSA (RIOTS)

33. **Mr. Wilson Harris** asked the Secretary of State for Foreign Affairs whether he has any information about the riots and massacres in Formosa in March; what is the present situation in the island; and whether the allocation of Formosa to China is definitive or provisional.

Mr. Mayhew: As a result of local discontent over alleged misrule, serious rioting and bloodshed occurred in Formosa at the end of February and beginning of March. Order was restored following the despatch of Chinese Government troops to the island. A new Governor has been appointed and, a number of reforms effected. No further incidents have been reported since the end of March. As regards the last part of the question, it was agreed in the Cairo Declaration of December, 1943, that Formosa should be returned to China. It is the view of His Majesty's Government that formal transfer of territories formerly owned or annexed by Japan must await the eventual Peace Conference with Japan.

Mr. Wilson Harris: Will my hon. Friend say what was the estimated number of deaths in these massacres; does he not agree that a very unsatisfactory situation was revealed as taking place in Formosa; has he the matter under observation; and has he asked the Far Eastern Commission and the Inter-Allied Control Council to intervene to promote a balanced administration in the country?

Mr. Mayhew: On the first part of the supplementary question, some 800 Formosans and Chinese are reported to have been killed in the suppression of the rioting, and a reliable observer has said that at least 250 mainland Chinese were killed in the rioting of 28th February last. On the second part of the Question, the Far Eastern Commission and the Control Council would not have any responsibility here, as Formosa has been under Chinese administration and remains so.

Mr. Wilson Harris: Do I understand from that reply that, whatever the responsibility for riots and massacres of this order, no steps should be taken by the Allies?

Mr. Mayhew: The formal transfer of this territory must await the Peace Conference with Japan.

BRITISH AUTHOR'S FLAT, FLORENCE (RESTORATION)

41. **Mr. Delberg** asked the Secretary of State for Foreign Affairs if he is aware that a flat at 24, Lungarno delle Grazie, Florence, Italy, the property of Mr. Norman Douglas, has been occupied at a nominal rent since 1941 by Italian Fascists; that repeated notices to quit have been unavailing, despite an assurance given to Mr. Douglas on behalf of the property adviser to the British Embassy, Rome, that the flat would probably be restored to him last March; that considerable inconvenience and hardship are thus caused to a distinguished author who is, moreover, debarred from